



HOW TO MAKE A TEATIME PLANTER

Materials

- * Old metal tray
- * Butyl liner & scissors
- * Strong outdoor adhesive & paintbrush
- * Vintage teacups, teapot & milk jug
- * Masking tape
- * Electric drill & ceramic drill bit
- * Gravel & small scoop or spoon
- * John Innes No.2 potting compost
- * Horticultural grit
- * Slow-release fertilizer granules
- * Strong galvanized chain
- * Wire cutters
- * 3 small galvanized metal hooks
- * Large galvanized metal ring
- * Strong metal hanging bracket, fixed securely to a wall
- * Vintage cutlery (optional)
- * Silver florist wire or similar

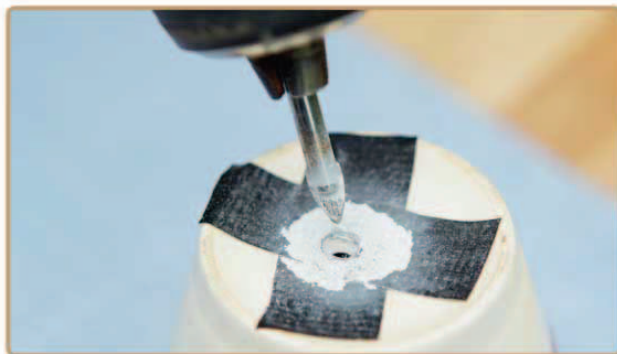


Plant list

- * Carpet moss
- * *Armeria juniperifolia* 'Bevan's Variety'
- * *Erigeron karvinskianus*
- * *Pratia peduncularis*
- * *Rhodohypoxis deflexa*
- * *Sisyrinchium californicum* 'Brachypus'



1 Cut a piece of butyl (you could use pond liner or a heavy-duty dustbin bag) to fit inside the base of the tray. Glue it into place with outdoor adhesive.



2 Take your cups, teapot, and milk jug and make a cross with two pieces of masking tape over the centre area where you intend to drill a hole; this helps prevent the drill from slipping and creates a clean cut. Drill drainage holes in the base of the items using an electric drill with a ceramic tile drill bit.



3 Create an attractive arrangement with your crockery on the lined tray and then glue the saucers in place and remove the cups, teapot, and jug for planting up.



4 Alpines need good drainage, so to plant up first fill the base of the crockery with a layer of gravel. Next, make a soil mix suitable for alpine plants by blending John Innes No. 2 potting compost with horticultural grit at a ratio of 3:1. At the same time, mix in a small amount of slow-release fertilizer.